has itself presented would naturally be substantial only for the Soviet side," I wrote: *"Because they have the most."*

"Only one thing," he wrote, "would be the result of such a one sided approach—an upsetting of the existing balance of forces and a break of that very stability which the U.S. side is allegedly so anxious to ensure."

("He means 'imbalance,'" I wrote.)

"There should be no misunderstanding, Mr. President. This is not a realistic position, not the path toward agreement. Besides, as you know, we are not the only ones who hold such a view." (This was apparently a reference to the disarmament movement in Europe.) Brezhnev proposed an immediate freeze on the number of nuclear weapons on both sides. "Such an agreement would, in our view, create favorable conditions for the negotiations and facilitate achieving the objectives therein. I would ask you, Mr. President, carefully to consider this proposal." (My note in the margin: *"I have and it is an apple for an orchard")* Brezhnev continued: "The Soviet people—and you can take my word for that—will resolutely support such an agreement," to which I wrote in the margin: *"How will they know? They haven't been told the truth for years."* At the bottom of the letter, I wrote: *"He's a barrel of laughs."*

Some of the frank things I was saying about the Soviet Union in the spring of 1982, I was told, caused concern among several of our European allies who had their hands full with the nuclear freeze movement, which was being fired up by demagogues depicting me as a shoot-from-the-hip cowboy aching to pull out my nuclear six-shooter and bring on doomsday.

Partly because of these concerns, when I went in June 1982 to the economic summit in Versailles, I accepted invitations to address the parliaments of Great Britain and West Germany. I wanted to demonstrate that I wasn't flirting with doomsday. I told the Europeans how I felt: A nuclear